active monks was implemented in 1964. The Buddha Sasana Sangha Organization was formed in an attempt to control Buddhist activity in Burma. By the following year, Ne Win would move against monastic autonomy and attempt to nationalize the sangha. Hundreds of monks were arrested for engaging in antigovernment activities. Furthermore, Baptist and Catholic missionary activities had ceased because any remaining missionaries were forced out by the mid-1960s. By all indications, the Revolutionary Council was trying to assert control over independent religious activities. When challenged or threatened by the religious hierarchy, the council took a hard-line stance that would be the order of the day in Burma for the foreseeable future.

## FOREIGN POLICY AND THE INSURGENCY ISSUE

An additional goal of the new government was to rid the country of foreign influence. Ne Win was believed to harbor intense animosity toward foreigners, especially Indians. The Indian community had been reduced during World War II. Ne Win implemented anti-Indian policies in 1964, forcing thousands of citizens out of the country. Many families had been in Burma for generations. They spoke Burmese and were an integral part of the social and cultural landscape. No compensation was given to the Indian population when 400,000 Indian citizens were forcibly removed. Vibrant members of the Burmese community such as doctors, lawyers, shopkeepers, businessmen, and teachers left en masse. This xenophobic action harmed not only the Burmese economy, but also the society in general. Burma did not suffer any significant backlash from the Indian state, which took in many of the individuals as refugees.

The China-Burma relationship was somewhat more complicated. During U Nu's tenure, the People's Republic of China (PRC) stayed neutral, refusing to give any significant support to the communist insurgency in Burma. Peking had actually been a key leader in the Non-Aligned Movement formed at Bandung in 1955. The PRC actually renounced any connections with the Burmese communist movement. With the emergence of the Revolutionary Council, the policy regarding the communist insurgents was bound to change.